JDM Journal, Peru

First International Metallurgy Conference

Lima, Cusco and Machu Picchu

23 – 30 October 2012

Tuesday, 23 October 2012

The connections and flights from SLC through Atlanta to Lima were fine. We left SLC at about 11:30 am Tuesday 23 October 2012. I was well cared for with 1st Class and Business Class accommodations. Meals included a Philly cheese steak sandwich and a stuffed chicken breast. The connection at Atlanta was a bit tight with a change of concourse. I think I was the last person to join the flight to Lima. The Business Class seating was different than I had experienced before. There was no one beside me as was thought from the seating plan we had seen on the computer. The seats were designed to completely horizontal and I was able to sleep a bit. We arrived at about 11 pm and to the Sheraton by 12:30 am on the 24th.

Wednesday, 24 October 2012.

I slept well at the Sheraton and arose about 8 am. I was surprised to be greeted at breakfast by Vicki and Rocky Sohn. We had a nice breakfast together and discussed the status of our families, among other things. Rocky is giving his short course today. My short course lectures are tomorrow, Thursday afternoon. After breakfast I prepared for lectures and attended to some email correspondence. One message I had was from Luis Roman. Luis and Maria are in Vancouver but Luis had contacted his colleagues at National University of Engineering, UNI, and they (Lily Ponce, Oscar Silva, others) plan to take me for dinner tonight, Wednesday night.



Rocky and Vicki Sohn, Lima, Peru (October 2012)

Alfredo Olaya, my host for this trip, contacted me this afternoon at the Sheraton in order to arrange for activities (short courses) tomorrow. Short course lectures for tomorrow include "Advances in Liberation Analysis" and "Fundamental Aspects of Flotation Chemistry". I think they have scheduled 6 hours for these lectures. I trust the Lord will sustain me for such a marathon.

We had dinner at the Sheraton tonight, Wednesday 24 October 2012, with Professors/Researchers at UNI including Lily Ponce, Oscar Silva, Juan Zegarra, Jorge Horna, Juvitza Perez, and Hernan Parra. It was a long evening but quite enjoyable, very hospitable. They were all very glad to see me and wanted me to visit UNI. Collaboration on research projects was discussed and the General Manager of the Chapi Laboratory, Maria Luisa Pecho, sent a gift “Minerals of Peru.” I always love to get such a gift, in fact, Oscar had given a similar gift on one of my previous visits to UNI. We had a good time together this evening. Buenos noches from Lima, for my old girl friend in SLC.



JDM displaying “Minerals of Peru” gift from Maria Luisa Pecho, General Manager, Chapi Laboratory. Left to right: Oscar Silva, JDM and Juan Zegarra



Dinner at the Sheraton. Left to right: Juan Zegarra, Juvitza Perez, Hernan Parra, JDM, Lili Ponce, Jorge Horna and Oscar Silva



Front Row, Left to right: Oscar Silva, Lili Ponce, JDM, and Juan Zegarra
Back Row, Left to right: Hernan Para, Juvitza Perez and Jorge Horna

Thursday, 25 October 2012

Not too much to report. All is well. All the mornings begin with fog coming in from the coast. The Sheraton is in the Miraflores area of Lima, close to the ocean. The food and accommodations are great. A number of researchers from North America are in attendance. Fathi Habashi and his wife are here.

Thursday, 25 October, began with breakfast at the Sheraton. The short course from 3 pm-10 pm was at the Ministry of Mines, about 15 minutes from the Sheraton. Boy, was I exhausted. No dinner for me on Thursday night. At least some of the participants, ~30, appreciated the information and engaged me in discussion.



JDM delivering a presentation at the First International Metallurgy Conference, Lima, Peru (October 2012)

Friday, 26 October 2012

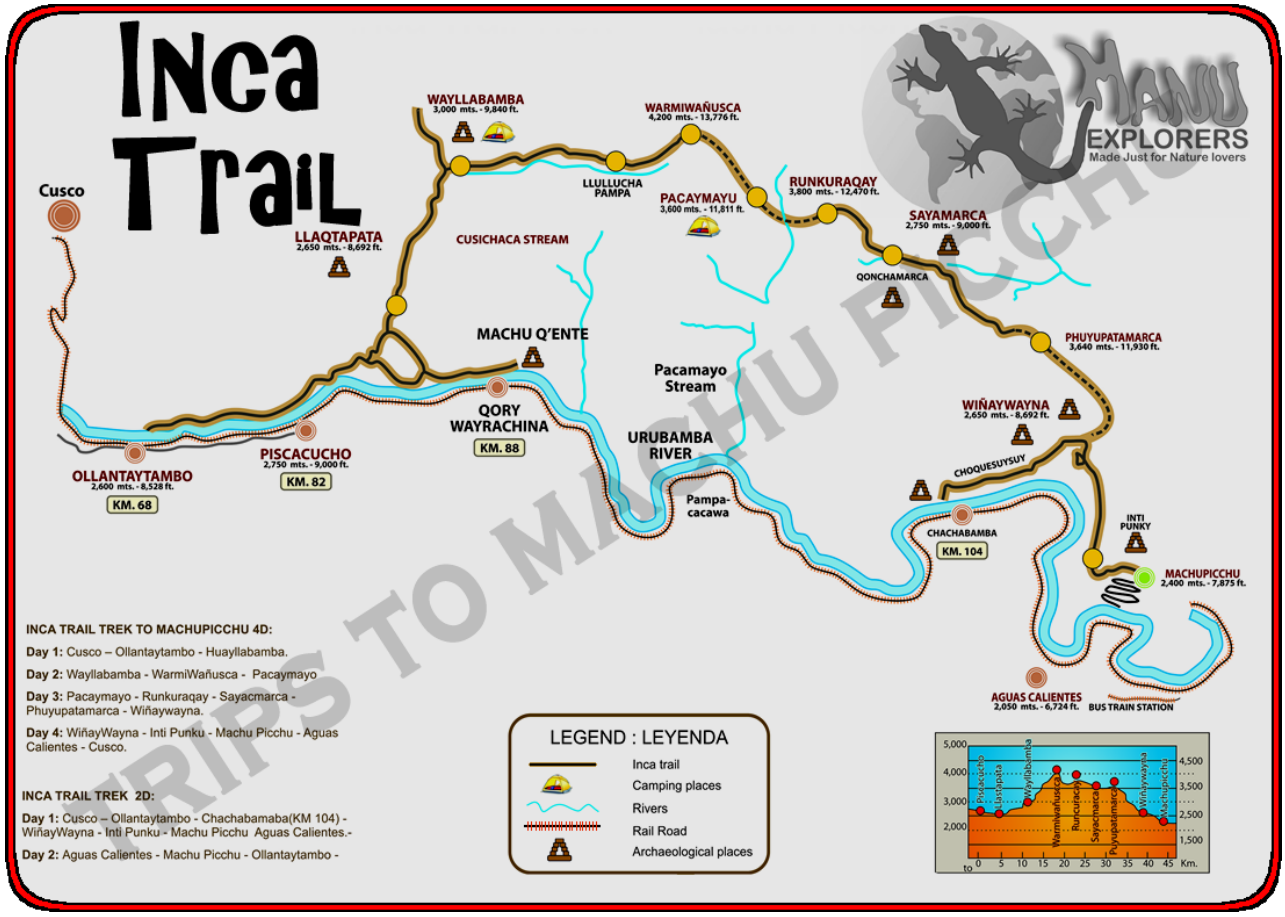
On Friday, 26 October, the conference began with lectures in the Sheraton. We had breakfast at the Sheraton. My lecture at noon today went well and we had an excellent lunch for the invited speakers. Tonight we have a Welcoming Reception with additional technical sessions scheduled for tomorrow.

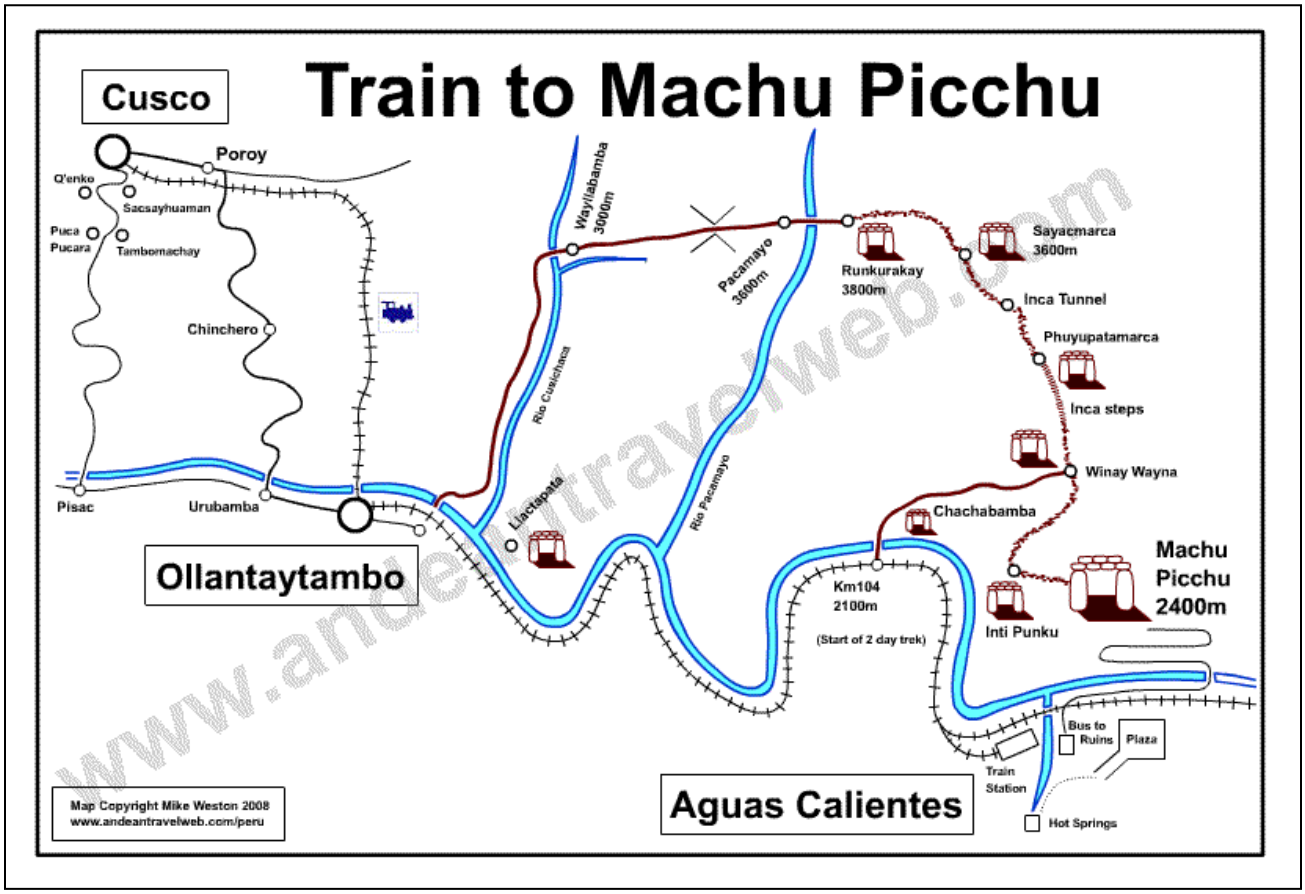
Tomorrow, Saturday 27 October, I will give my last lecture and then leave on an early afternoon flight on Lan Peru to Cusco.

Saturday, 27 October 2012

I had breakfast at the Sheraton, then packed before the session started this morning because I had to take a taxi right after my presentation to catch the Lan Peru flight to Cusco. The presentation on activated carbon went well; the room was packed. I suppose that we had 100 in attendance. An old student who attended the U of U arrived today and was excited to see me after 20,30 years. I think his name is Federico Calisaya. Anyway he brought a bottle of Peruvian liquor for me, a special high quality Pisco. Of course I could not take it and had it delivered to our host, Alfredo Olaya.

I made the Lan Peru flight and boarded without trouble. The Andes were shrouded in clouds during our descent into Cusco. As we landed I was reminded of one of our favorite stories, “Runner for the King,” and how exciting it was during the time of the Incas. Of course I thought we should all be a Runner for the King of Kings. In any case I was collected at the airport by Elvis from Paracas Travel. The schedule calls for me to leave by train for Machu Picchu tomorrow morning at 6 am. I am on my own so its a little bit of concern. All the bookings have been OK so far. I am at the Samay Hotel in Cusco tonight and tomorrow night.


Inca Trail
Cusco
LLAQTAPATA
2,650 mts. - 8,692 ft.
WAYLLABAMBA
3,000 mts. - 9,840 ft.
LLULLUCHA PAMPA
WARMIWAÑUSCA
4,200 mts. - 13,776 ft.
PACAYMAYU
3,600 mts. - 11,811 ft.
RUNKURAQAY
3,800 mts. - 12,470 ft.
SAYAMARCA
2,750 mts. - 9,000 ft.
QONCHAMARCA
CUSICHACA STREAM
MACHU Q'ENTE
Pacamayo Stream
PHUYUPATAMARCA
3,640 mts. - 11,930 ft.
WIÑAYWAYNA
2,650 mts. - 8,692 ft.
QORY WAYRACHINA
KM. 88
URUBAMBA RIVER
CHOQUESUYSUY
Pampa-cacawa
PISCACUCHO
2,750 mts. - 9,000 ft.
KM. 82
OLLANTAYTAMBO
2,600 mts. - 8,528 ft.
KM. 68
CHACHABAMBA
KM. 104
INTI PUNKY
MACHUPICCHU
2,400 mts. - 7,875 ft.
AGUAS CALIENTES
2,050 mts. - 6,724 ft.
BUS TRAIN STATION
MANU EXPLORERS
Made Just for Nature lovers
INCA TRAIL TREK TO MACHUPICCHU 4D:
Day 1: Cusco – Ollantaytambo - Huayllabamba.
Day 2: Wayllabamba - WarmiWañusca - Pacaymayo
Day 3: Pacaymayo - Runkuraqay - Sayacmarca - Phuyupatamarca - Wiñaywayna.
Day 4: WiñayWayna - Inti Punku - Machu Picchu - Aguas Calientes - Cusco.
INCA TRAIL TREK 2D:
Day 1: Cusco – Ollantaytambo - Chachabamaba(KM 104) - WiñayWayna - Inti Punku - Machu Picchu Aguas Calientes.-
Day 2: Aguas Calientes - Machu Picchu - Ollantaytambo -
LEGEND : LEYENDA
Inca trail
Camping places
Rivers
Rail Road
Archaeological places
5,000
4,000
3,000
2,000
4,500
3,500
2,500
1,500
0 5 10 15 20 25 30 35 40 45 Km.
Piscacucho
Llactapata
Wayllabamba
Warmiwañusca
Runcuracay
Sayacmarca
Phuyupatamarca
Wiñaywayna
Machupicchu
TRIPS TO MACHU PICCHU



I don't have a good internet connection and no English news station on TV. I guess I will try to find the Penn State score on the internet if I am lucky.

Sunday, 28 October 2012

The day started early in Cusco at the Samay Hotel with a 5 am wakeup call, shower, breakfast and then on our way with my contact Elvis and a driver to take us to the Poroy station for departure on Peru Rail to Machu Picchu, 3 to 4 hour trip. The train carriages were of special design, vista dome carriages, to facilitate our viewing pleasure. Of course Cusco and the surrounding region, particularly Machu Picchu remain the center of historic Inca culture with visitors and tourists to Machu Picchu limited to 2500 people per day. I am glad my ticket had been arranged in advance by Alfredo Olaya who had organized the conference in Lima and made this experience possible.



Peru Rail – Train from
Cusco to Machu Picchu

This amazing portion of the Andes has spectacular vistas, mountain peaks reaching 5000 meters shrouded in clouds, many gorges and ravines. The Urubama River flows through this region on its way to the Amazon, quite amazing that almost all the water flows to the east. Cusco is about 3600 meters in elevation while Machu Picchu is at a lower elevation of 2400 meters. As you travel on the railroad and change elevations the climate changes from dry and cooler in Cusco to wet, humid and warm in Machu Picchu which is the beginning of the high jungle. In fact botanical gardens are maintained at Machu Picchu with many varieties of orchids and on further into the high mountain jungle.

Peru Rail is the only way to reach Machu Picchu, actually you reach the station, Aqua Calientes or Hot Springs, and then have to travel by bus 1500 meters vertically with lots of switch backs to reach the sacred palace of the Incas. There is one other alternative and that is the Inca Trail, the trail supposedly used by the Incas and as discussed in "Runner for the King." I expect Jenny would enjoy this expedition, 40 km and 3 nights on the trail with guides and porters of course. On the train we discussed such an expedition that had just been completed by a young couple. They were exhausted but had enjoyed the adventure immensely. All this experience brought back memories of "Runner for the King" and I could imagine the boy runner, Roca, with his quipu desperately making his way to Machu Picchu to warn the Emperor of the invasion, struggling with the enemy and fighting a panther in one of these ravines.



Peru Rail – Stop for the
Inca Trail to hike to
Machu Picchu

Well we finally reached Machu Picchu which was credited to the 9th Inca King, Pachacutec, in 1430. Machu Picchu consists of three sectors, terraces, religious, and urban. There are so many things to describe but one item of interest is that Machu Picchu was never found by the Spaniards when they invaded in 1536. In fact it was not until about 1902 that the lost city of the Incas, Machu Picchu, was rediscovered by a Peruvian farmer from the Cusco area. Eventually the President of Peru heard the story and alerted Hiram Bingham, a professor from Yale. With the help of National Geographic, Hiram began the archaeological study and restoration of Machu Picchu in 1912.



View from Machu
Picchu to the valley
below and the Urabama
River





JDM and Machu Picchu – the Lost City of the Incas



The restoration of the lost city of the Incas was most interesting with many different buildings and organization of the community. They were quite self sufficient, raising crops on the terraces and maintaining llama and alpaca herds. Also we saw chinchillas, large animals like a rabbit but with incredibly fine fur. From the city of Machu Picchu we could see Happy Mountain and Young Mountain as well as other spectacular sites. The Incas made sacrifices to their gods Sun and Moon, they were big on astronomy, constellations, marking the solstices, god of the earth, and another god. They had a special house for young girls, virgins of the sun, who if not sacrificed, were taken as concubines for the Inca King. The sacrifice of the virgins was strange. As I understand it involved drugging them and then burying them in a glacier with appropriate ceremony, of course. I need to read further to make sure I understood what Antonita, our tour guide, said.





Llama (above) and chinchilla (right) at Machu Picchu

The return by bus and descent of 1500 meters to the station at Aqua Calientes was exciting with many switch backs and encounters with other buses on the way to Machu Picchu. The return by train was fine but I was tired with all the climbing we did during the tour. We arrived at the Poroy Station and I was collected by Elvis for return to the Samay Hotel in Cusco. Dinner consisted of a cheeseburger and french fries.

Monday, 29 October 2012

Not much planned for today, mainly preparation for the return to Salt Lake City. After a shower, shave and breakfast at the Samay, I worked on a research paper and packed for my Lan Peru flight from Cusco to Lima this afternoon. I am scheduled to arrive in Lima at about 6 pm with departure at midnight for Atlanta on Delta. So I will have to organize my time for the 6 hours in the Lima International Airport. I expect to arrive in SLC Tuesday morning, if all goes well. Already, thanks are being given for this interesting journey and the opportunity to experience a bit more of the creation.





